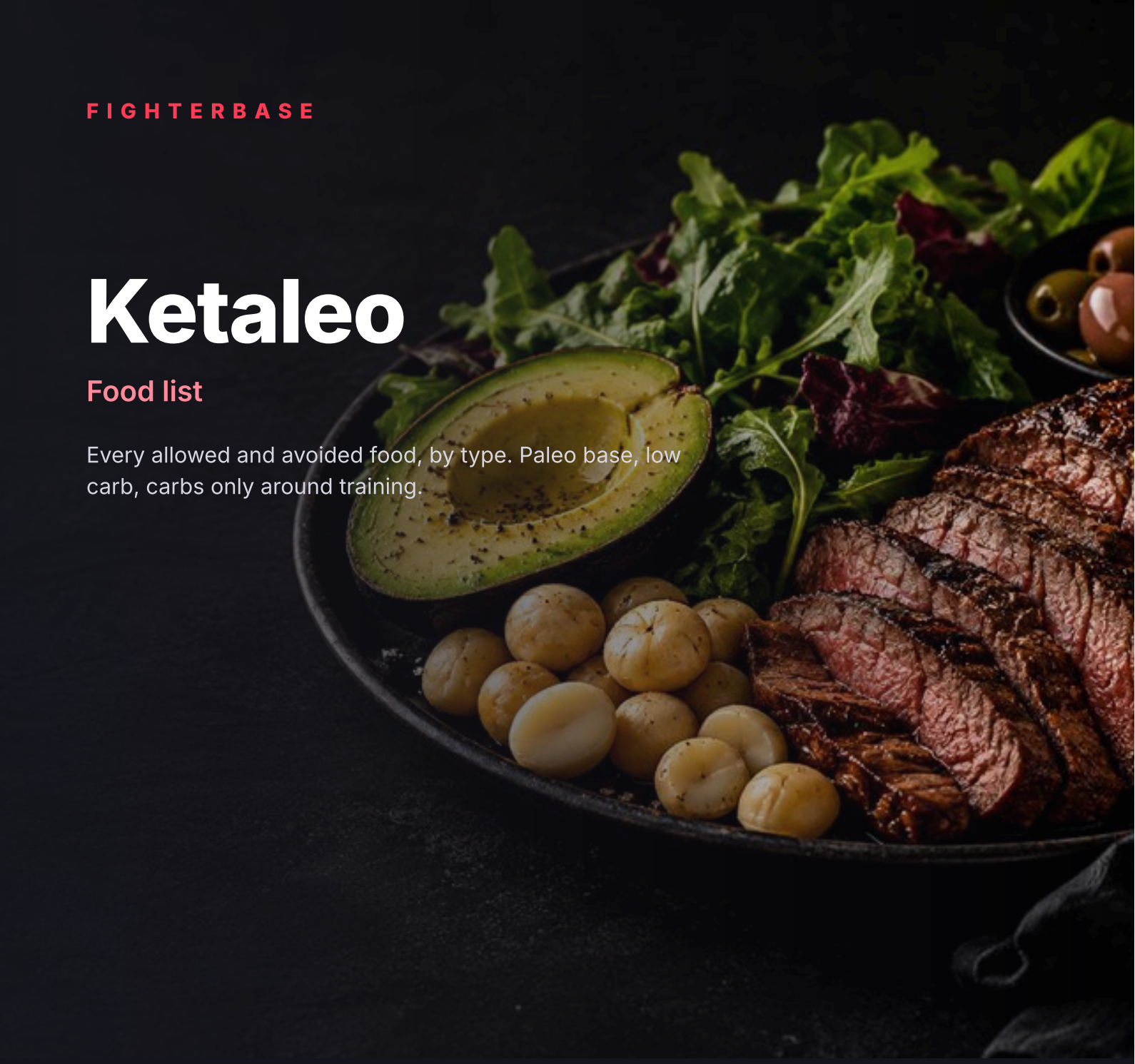
FIGHTERBASE



Ketaleo

Food list

Every allowed and avoided food, by type. Paleo base, low carb, carbs only around training.

Prepared 11 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

> DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

How to use this food list

This food list is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Ketaleo**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

The colour key

Green	Amber	Red	Blue
Allowed. Fits this style.	In moderation, small amounts or some versions.	Avoid. The reason is shown.	Check the label or how it is made.

224	68	213	0
allowed	in moderation	avoid	check label

Brand products vary. This list is built from the FighterBase food catalogue of 505 common foods. If a food is not here, ask which group it belongs to and check the label.

AT A GLANCE

Ketaleo on one page

A paleo-keto blend: paleo foods all day, kept low carb, with carbs eaten only in a window around training.

Mostly yes

- Beef steak (sirloin, rump, ribeye, fillet)
- Beef mince (5% to 20% fat)
- Salmon (fresh, farmed or wild)
- Trout
- Hen eggs (whole)
- Egg whites (carton)
- Spinach
- Kale
- Swede and turnip
- Celeriac
- Strawberries
- Blueberries
- Almonds
- Walnuts
- Extra virgin olive oil
- Olive oil (light)

Mostly no

- White bread
- Wholemeal and granary bread
- Wheat pasta (white or wholewheat)
- Egg pasta and fresh pasta
- Whole milk
- Semi-skimmed and skimmed milk
- Cheddar
- Parmesan and grana padano (animal rennet)
- Red lentils
- Green and brown lentils
- White and brown sugar
- Honey
- Tofu (firm, silken, smoked)
- Tempeh
- Coffee with milk or cream
- Hot chocolate

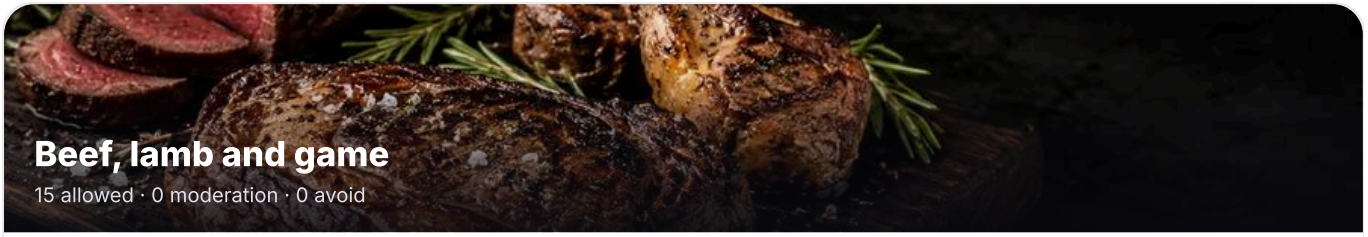
The big ideas

1. Carbs stay very low, as in keto.
2. Foods come from the paleo list: meat, fish, eggs, non-starchy vegetables, nuts, seeds, healthy fats.
3. No dairy (butter replaced by ghee or oils in some versions).
4. No grains, legumes, sugar or processed foods.
5. Count net carbs and watch fruit, nuts and hidden starch.

> **Talk to a professional first if:** You take medication for diabetes, blood pressure or epilepsy; You have kidney, liver or gall bladder problems; You are pregnant, breastfeeding or under 18; You have ever had an eating disorder.

THE FULL LIST

Every food, by type



Beef, lamb and game

15 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 15

Beef steak (sirloin, rump, ribeye, fillet) · Beef mince (5% to 20% fat) · Beef joint (topside, brisket, silverside) · Beef short ribs and oxtail · Beef burgers (home-made, 100% beef) · Lamb chops, leg and shoulder · Lamb mince · Mutton · Goat · Venison · Rabbit · Wild boar · Bison and buffalo · Pheasant, partridge and grouse · Veal



Pork and cured meats

5 allowed · 0 moderation · 9 avoid

ALLOWED 5

Pork loin, chops and tenderloin · Pork belly and pork shoulder · Pork mince · Gammon and ham joint · Lard

AVOID 9

Bacon (back and streaky) · processed · Sausages (pork) · processed · Sausages (beef or chicken, check the label) · processed · Ham slices (deli) · processed · Salami, chorizo and pepperoni · processed · Pork pies and scotch eggs · processed · Pate and liver sausage · processed · Black pudding · processed · Pulled pork (ready-made, sweetened sauce) · processed



Poultry

8 allowed · 0 moderation · 3 avoid

ALLOWED 8

Chicken breast · Chicken thighs and drumsticks (skin on or off) · Whole roast chicken · Chicken wings · Chicken mince · Turkey breast and turkey mince · Duck breast and duck leg · Goose

AVOID 3

Chicken nuggets and breaded chicken · processed · Chicken sausages and deli chicken slices · processed · Rotisserie chicken (shop-bought, check seasoning) · processed



Offal and bones

10 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 10

Liver (beef, lamb, chicken) · Kidney · Heart · Tongue · Tripe · Bone marrow · Bone broth (home-made) · Beef dripping and tallow · Duck fat and goose fat · Gelatine and collagen powder



Fish

26 allowed · 0 moderation · 5 avoid

ALLOWED 26

Salmon (fresh, farmed or wild) · Trout · Mackerel · Sardines (fresh or tinned in oil or water) · Herring and kippers · Anchovies · Pilchards · Tuna (fresh steak) · Tuna (tinned) · Cod · Haddock · Pollock and coley · Plaice and sole · Sea bass and sea bream · Halibut and turbot · Hake · Whitebait · Skate · Monkfish · Swordfish · Catfish · Eel · Shark · Sturgeon and caviar · Fish roe (cod roe, salmon roe) · Cod liver oil

AVOID 5

Smoked salmon · processed · Fish fingers and breaded fish · processed · Fish cakes · processed · Fish paste and pate · processed · Surimi and crab sticks · processed



Shellfish and seafood

13 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 13

Prawns and shrimp · King prawns and tiger prawns · Crab · Lobster · Langoustine and crayfish · Mussels · Oysters · Scallops · Clams and cockles · Whelks and winkles · Squid and calamari · Octopus · Cuttlefish



Eggs

5 allowed · 0 moderation · 3 avoid

ALLOWED 5

Hen eggs (whole) · Egg whites (carton) · Duck eggs · Quail eggs · Omelette and scrambled egg

AVOID
3

Mayonnaise · industrial seed oil | Egg noodles · contains gluten | Meringue · added sugar



Milk and cream

0 allowed · 2 moderation · 9 avoid

MODERATION
2

Butter · some people allow butter | Ghee (clarified butter) · some people allow clarified butter

AVOID
9

Whole milk · dairy | Semi-skimmed and skimmed milk · dairy | Lactose-free milk · dairy | Goat's milk and sheep's milk · dairy | Single, double and whipping cream · dairy | Soured cream and creme fraiche · dairy | Condensed and evaporated milk · dairy | Milk powder · dairy | Buttermilk · dairy



Yoghurt, kefir and soft cheeses

0 allowed · 0 moderation · 12 avoid

AVOID
12

Plain natural yoghurt · dairy | Greek yoghurt · dairy | Skyr · dairy | Flavoured and fruit yoghurt · dairy | Kefir · dairy | Cottage cheese · dairy | Quark · dairy | Cream cheese · dairy | Ricotta · dairy | Mascarpone · dairy | Mozzarella · dairy | Paneer · dairy



Hard and mature cheeses

0 allowed · 0 moderation · 15 avoid

AVOID
15

Cheddar · dairy | Parmesan and grana padano (animal rennet) · dairy | Edam and gouda · dairy | Emmental and gruyere · dairy | Brie and camembert · dairy | Blue cheese (stilton, gorgonzola) · dairy | Feta · dairy | Halloumi · dairy | Goat's cheese · dairy | Processed cheese slices and spreads · dairy | Whey protein · dairy | Casein protein · dairy | Ice cream · dairy | Custard and milk puddings · dairy | Milkshakes · dairy



Plant proteins and soy

1 allowed · 0 moderation · 11 avoid

ALLOWED 1

Nutritional yeast

AVOID 11

Tofu (firm, silken, smoked) · soy
Tempeh · soy
Edamame · soy
Soya mince and soya chunks · soy
Soya milk and soya yoghurt · soy
Seitan (wheat protein) · contains gluten
Quorn and mycoprotein (many contain egg white) · processed
Plant-based burgers and sausages · processed
Pea protein and rice protein powder · legume
Miso · soy
Natto · soy



Beans, lentils and pulses

0 allowed · 3 moderation · 21 avoid

MODERATION 3

Green beans and runner beans · carbs add up, keep small
Garden peas and petits pois · carbs add up, keep small
Mangetout and sugar snap peas · carbs add up, keep small

AVOID 21

Red lentils · legume
Green and brown lentils · legume
Puy lentils · legume
Chickpeas · legume
Black beans · legume
Kidney beans · legume
Cannellini and haricot beans · legume
Butter beans · legume
Pinto beans · legume
Borlotti beans · legume
Broad beans · legume
Black-eyed peas · legume
Split peas · legume
Lupin beans · legume
Hummus · legume
Falafel · legume
Baked beans in tomato sauce · legume
Refried beans · legume
Peanuts · legume
Peanut butter · legume
Bean and lentil pasta · legume



Bread and bakery

2 allowed · 2 moderation · 22 avoid

ALLOWED 2

Almond-flour bread and wraps
Coconut-flour wraps

MODERATION 2

Corn tortillas · carbs, training window only
Oatcakes · carbs, training window only

AVOID
22

White bread · contains gluten
Wholemeal and granary bread · contains gluten
Sourdough bread · contains gluten
Rye bread · contains gluten
Seeded bread · contains gluten
Gluten-free bread · processed
Pitta and flatbreads · contains gluten
Wraps and tortillas (wheat) · contains gluten
Naan and chapati · contains gluten
Bagels · contains gluten
Crumpets and muffins · contains gluten
Croissants and pastries · contains gluten
Pizza base · contains gluten
Crackers and crispbreads · contains gluten
Rice cakes · processed
Cakes and sponge · contains gluten
Biscuits and cookies · contains gluten
Doughnuts · contains gluten
Pies and pasties · contains gluten
Cereal bars and flapjacks · added sugar
Protein bars · added sugar
Cloud bread · dairy



Pasta, rice and grains

6 allowed · 19 moderation · 16 avoid

ALLOWED
6

Chia pudding
Cauliflower rice
Courgette noodles (courgetti)
Konjac (shirataki) noodles
Flours: almond
Flours: coconut

MODERATION
19

Rice noodles · carbs, training window only
Glass noodles · carbs, training window only
White rice (basmati, jasmine, long-grain) · carbs, training window only
Brown rice · carbs, training window only
Wild rice · carbs, training window only
Risotto rice · carbs, training window only
Oats (rolled and porridge) · carbs, training window only
Oat bran · carbs, training window only
Quinoa · carbs, training window only
Buckwheat · carbs, training window only
Amaranth · carbs, training window only
Millet · carbs, training window only
Sorghum · carbs, training window only
Teff · carbs, training window only
Polenta and cornmeal · carbs, training window only
Sweetcorn and corn on the cob · carbs, training window only
Popcorn · carbs, training window only
Flours: rice, cornflour and maize · carbs, training window only
Flours: tapioca and arrowroot · carbs, training window only

AVOID
16

Wheat pasta (white or wholewheat) · contains gluten
Egg pasta and fresh pasta · contains gluten
Gluten-free pasta (corn or rice) · processed
Noodles (wheat) and ramen · contains gluten
Couscous · contains gluten
Bulgur wheat · contains gluten
Semolina · contains gluten
Freekeh, spelt, farro and kamut · contains gluten
Barley and pearl barley · contains gluten
Sushi rice · added sugar
Muesli and granola · added sugar
Breakfast cereals (cornflakes, bran flakes) · contains gluten
Shredded wheat and wheat biscuits · contains gluten
Tortilla chips · processed
Flours: wheat and plain · contains gluten
Flours: chickpea (gram) · legume





Leafy and salad vegetables

12 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 12

Spinach · Kale · Cabbage (green, red, savoy) · Spring greens and collards · Lettuce and salad leaves · Rocket and watercress · Chard · Pak choi and bok choy · Cucumber · Celery · Radishes · Bean sprouts



Cruciferous and stalk vegetables

10 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 10

Broccoli · Cauliflower · Brussels sprouts · Asparagus · Fennel · Artichoke · Kohlrabi · Leeks · Courgette and marrow · Aubergine



Onions, peppers and tomatoes

10 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 10

Onions and shallots · Garlic · Spring onions and chives · Peppers (red, green, yellow) · Chillies · Tomatoes (fresh, tinned, passata) · Tomato puree · Mushrooms (all types) · Olives · Avocado



Roots, squash and starchy vegetables

11 allowed · 11 moderation · 2 avoid

ALLOWED 11

Swede and turnip · Celeriac · Sweet potato · Plantain · Seaweed and nori · Sauerkraut · Kimchi · Pickles and gherkins · Frozen vegetables (plain) · Tinned vegetables (no added sugar) · Vegetable juice

MODERATION 11

Carrots · carbs add up, keep small · Beetroot · carbs add up, keep small · Parsnips · carbs add up, keep small · Butternut squash and pumpkin · carbs add up, keep small · White potatoes (boiled, baked, mashed) · carbs, training window only · Chips (home-made, oven) · carbs, training window only · Roast potatoes · carbs, training window only · Yam · carbs, training window only · Cassava (yuca) and tapioca · carbs, training window only · Taro · carbs, training window only · Jerusalem artichoke · carbs, training window only

AVOID 2

- Chips and fries (takeaway or frozen) · processed
- Parsnip and potato crisps (vegetable crisps) · processed



Fruit

7 allowed · 21 moderation · 8 avoid

ALLOWED 7

- Strawberries
- Blueberries
- Raspberries
- Blackberries
- Cranberries and redcurrants
- Lemons and limes
- Coconut (fresh flesh)

MODERATION 21

- Apples · carbs, training window only
- Pears · carbs, training window only
- Oranges and satsumas · carbs, training window only
- Grapefruit · carbs add up, keep small
- Peaches and nectarines · carbs add up, keep small
- Plums · carbs add up, keep small
- Apricots · carbs add up, keep small
- Cherries · carbs, training window only
- Kiwi · carbs add up, keep small
- Melon (cantaloupe, honeydew) · carbs add up, keep small
- Watermelon · carbs add up, keep small
- Pineapple · carbs, training window only
- Mango · carbs, training window only
- Papaya · carbs add up, keep small
- Grapes · carbs, training window only
- Bananas · carbs, training window only
- Figs (fresh) · carbs, training window only
- Pomegranate · carbs, training window only
- Passion fruit · carbs add up, keep small
- Smoothies (home-made, whole fruit) · carbs, training window only
- Coconut water · carbs, training window only

AVOID 8

- Dates · added sugar
- Raisins, sultanas and currants · added sugar
- Dried apricots, figs and prunes · added sugar
- Other dried fruit and fruit leather · added sugar
- Tinned fruit in juice · added sugar
- Tinned fruit in syrup · added sugar
- Fruit juice · added sugar
- Smoothies (shop-bought) · added sugar



Nuts and seeds

17 allowed · 4 moderation · 3 avoid

ALLOWED 17

- Almonds
- Walnuts
- Pecans
- Hazelnuts
- Brazil nuts
- Macadamias
- Pine nuts
- Mixed nuts (plain)
- Chia seeds
- Flaxseed (linseed)
- Hemp seeds
- Pumpkin seeds
- Sunflower seeds
- Sesame seeds and tahini
- Poppy seeds
- Almond butter
- Coconut flakes and desiccated coconut

MODERATION 4

- Cashews · carbs add up, keep small
- Pistachios · carbs add up, keep small
- Chestnuts · carbs, training window only
- Cashew butter · carbs add up, keep small

AVOID 3

- Salted and flavoured nuts · processed
- Trail mix (with dried fruit and chocolate) · added sugar
- Hazelnut chocolate spread · added sugar



Oils, fats and spreads

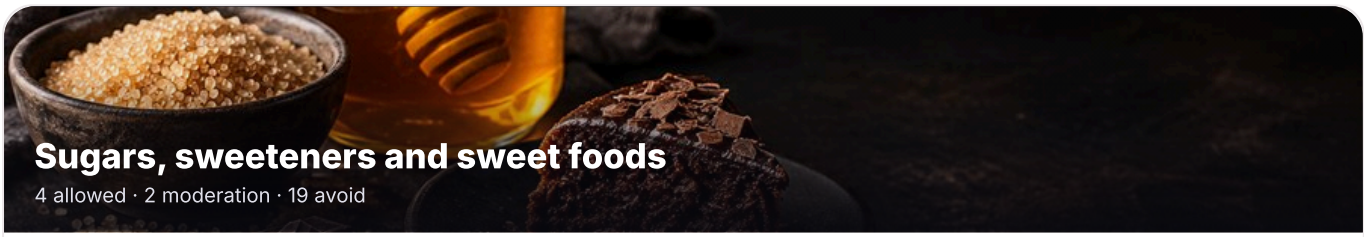
9 allowed · 0 moderation · 8 avoid

ALLOWED 9

- Extra virgin olive oil
- Olive oil (light)
- Avocado oil
- Coconut oil
- MCT oil
- Flaxseed oil
- Walnut oil
- Sesame oil
- Palm oil

AVOID 8

- Rapeseed (canola) oil · industrial seed oil
- Sunflower oil · industrial seed oil
- Vegetable oil and corn oil · industrial seed oil
- Soybean oil · industrial seed oil
- Margarine and baking spreads · industrial seed oil
- Dairy-free spreads · industrial seed oil
- Cooking spray · industrial seed oil
- Salad dressings (bottled) · industrial seed oil



Sugars, sweeteners and sweet foods

4 allowed · 2 moderation · 19 avoid

ALLOWED 4

- Stevia
- Monk fruit
- Erythritol and xylitol
- Cocoa powder (unsweetened)

MODERATION 2

- Dark chocolate 70% or higher · 85% cocoa or higher, a small square
- Dark chocolate 85% or higher · 85% cocoa or higher, a small square

AVOID 19

- White and brown sugar · added sugar
- Honey · added sugar
- Maple syrup · added sugar
- Agave syrup · added sugar
- Golden syrup, treacle and molasses · added sugar
- Date syrup and date paste · added sugar
- Coconut sugar · added sugar
- Aspartame, sucralose and saccharin · artificial sweetener
- Jam, marmalade and fruit spreads · added sugar
- Milk chocolate · added sugar
- White chocolate · added sugar
- Sweets, gummies and jelly · added sugar
- Marshmallows · added sugar
- Fizzy and boiled sweets · added sugar
- Energy gels and chews · added sugar
- Sherbet and candyfloss · added sugar
- Fruit pastilles and wine gums · added sugar
- Protein ice cream and low-sugar desserts · artificial sweetener
- Vegan chocolate · added sugar



Herbs, spices and flavourings

17 allowed · 0 moderation · 2 avoid

ALLOWED 17

Salt (sea, table, rock) · Black pepper · Basil, oregano, thyme and rosemary · Parsley, coriander, mint and dill · Sage, bay and tarragon · Cumin, coriander seed and fennel seed · Turmeric · Paprika and smoked paprika · Chilli flakes and cayenne · Cinnamon, nutmeg and cloves · Ginger (fresh and ground) · Garlic powder and onion powder · Mustard seeds · Vanilla (pods) · Vanilla extract (alcohol-based) · Curry powder and garam masala (check blends) · Mixed herbs and Italian seasoning

AVOID 2

Seasoning mixes and rubs (check label) · processed · Stock cubes and gravy granules · processed



Sauces and condiments

10 allowed · 0 moderation · 18 avoid

ALLOWED 10

Mustard (English, Dijon, wholegrain) · Coconut aminos · Fish sauce · Hot sauce (chilli) · Apple cider vinegar · White wine, red wine and rice vinegar · Dairy-free pesto · Salsa · Guacamole · Gravy (home-made, no flour)

AVOID 18

Tomato ketchup · added sugar · Brown sauce · added sugar · BBQ sauce · added sugar · Mayonnaise (light) · industrial seed oil · Soy sauce · soy · Tamari (wheat-free soy sauce) · soy · Oyster sauce · added sugar · Worcestershire sauce · contains gluten · Sriracha · added sugar · Balsamic vinegar · added sugar · Malt vinegar · contains gluten · Pesto (basil and pine nut) · dairy · Curry sauce (jar) · added sugar · Pasta sauce (jar) · added sugar · Sweet chilli sauce · added sugar · Teriyaki sauce · soy · Hoisin sauce · soy · Coleslaw (shop-bought) · industrial seed oil



Drinks

13 allowed · 2 moderation · 12 avoid

ALLOWED 13

Water (still and sparkling) · Tea (black, green, white) · Herbal and fruit teas · Coffee (black) · Decaffeinated coffee and tea · Electrolyte tablets and powders (sugar-free) · Almond, cashew and hazelnut milk · Coconut milk drink · Wine (red, white, rose) · Spirits (whisky, gin, vodka, rum) · Gluten-free beer · Alcohol-free beer · Bone broth drink

MODERATION 2

Oat milk · carbs, training window only · Rice milk · carbs, training window only

AVOID 12

Coffee with milk or cream · dairy | Hot chocolate · dairy | Squash and cordial · added sugar | Fizzy drinks (cola, lemonade) · added sugar | Diet and zero-sugar fizzy drinks · artificial sweetener | Energy drinks · added sugar | Sports drinks · added sugar | Pea milk · legume | Kombucha · added sugar | Beer and lager · contains gluten | Cider · added sugar | Liqueurs and alcopops · added sugar



Ready meals and takeaway

3 allowed · 2 moderation · 13 avoid

ALLOWED 3

Home-made vegetable soup | Salad with grilled chicken | Stir-fry (home-made)

MODERATION 2

Sushi · carbs, training window only | Jacket potato with filling · carbs, training window only

AVOID 13

Pizza · contains gluten | Burgers in buns · contains gluten | Kebabs · contains gluten | Fish and chips · contains gluten | Takeaway curry with rice · dairy | Chinese takeaway · soy | Sandwiches and subs · contains gluten | Crisps · processed | Pot noodles and instant noodles · contains gluten | Ready meals · processed | Tinned soup (check label) · processed | Sausage rolls · contains gluten | Burrito and fajitas · contains gluten



Supplements

10 allowed · 0 moderation · 2 avoid

ALLOWED 10

Creatine monohydrate | Fish oil (omega-3) | Algae omega-3 | Vitamin D3 (from lanolin) | Vitamin D (from lichen) | Multivitamin and mineral tablet | Magnesium | Caffeine tablets | BCAAs and EAAs | Collagen peptides

AVOID 2

Pea or rice protein · legume | Soy protein · soy

READ THE LABEL

Hidden ingredients

Ingredients can hide in the small print. Look for these on packaging, menus and supplements.

- Hidden carbs: maltodextrin, dextrose, starch
- Hidden dairy: whey, casein, lactose
- Sugar alcohols can count partly towards carbs

For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.